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FREE COMMISSARY PROGRAM GIVES 500 PACKAGES TO PRISON INMATES



Free Legal Aid Program coordinator LULLA HUDSON (left) helps OCLC Teen Club members fill some of the 500 Free Commissary packages that will be sent to inmates in prisons throughout the state of California.

(Oakland, Calif.) — The Free Prison Commissary Program, part of the Free Legal Aid and Educational Program of the Oakland Community Learning Center (OCLC), will send 500 packages containing clothing, food and other needed items to men and women incarcerated in California prisons this holiday season, it was announced at a press conference here last week.

Joan Kelley, OCLC programs director, and Lulla Hudson, coordinator of the Legal Aid Program, said that inmates at San Quentin Prison, California Medical Facility (Vacaville), Folsom Prison, Soledad Prison, California Men's Colony (San Luis Obispo), California Institution for Men (Chino), California Rehabilitation Center (Corona), Deuel Vocational Institute (Tracy) and the California Institution for Women (Frontera) would receive the free packages. Among the items they contain are shirts, jeans, windbreakers, socks, house slippers, underwear, dried fruits and meats, candies and cookies, cigarettes and toiletries such as deodorant, toothbrushes and lotion.

One of several components of the community-based Free Legal Aid Program, the Free Prison Commissary Program seeks to provide clothing, hygiene products, food and other human necessities to prison inmates, whose everyday needs are badly neglected by state prisons. At most California prisons, those commissary items that are provided cost so much that the majority of inmates cannot afford them.

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